

If you are short on that, consider chipping in with a friend and sharing a side. You'll each get some of the cuts you would have gotten if you bought the full side, but you won't have to carve out as much freezer space or lay out as much cash up front. Bonus? Everything comes custom-cut the way you want it, and prepackaged.

9. The half-and-half approach

This requires mixing 50% meat with 50% texturized vegetable pro-

tein (TVP), which I realize sounds like sacrilege to the true carnivore at heart. Consider, though, that if you already eat a fair amount of prepared meat products from the freezer aisle, you may be eating more of it than you think. A few places to work it in painlessly would be meatballs, chili, spaghetti sauce, and Sloppy Joes.

— **Myscha Theriault**

